Figure 1: Chrome extension loader interface to load/unload extensions

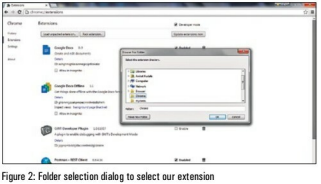

Figure 2: Folder selection dialog to select our extension

Creating an entry point

Open the *background.html* file and add the following HTML code:

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
<body>
  <script src="logic.js"></script>
</body>
</html>
```

This is the HTML code to load our extension's logic. So you are done; now let us load the extension.

Loading the extension

Generally, extensions for Chrome are packaged up as *.crx* files. Also, there is a quick alternative and user-friendly way of loading extensions.

1. Open up the Chrome menu by clicking the icon that's to the right of the address bar and select *Extensions* under the *Tools* menu or just enter 'chrome://extensions' in the address bar before hitting *Enter*, as shown in Figure 1.
2. Check the *Developer mode* checkbox in the top right-hand corner if it hasn't been checked.
3. Now, click on *Load unpacked extension*, which will open up the file-selection dialogue box, as shown in Figure 2.
4. Navigate to the directory where your extension files are, and select it.

   Another easy way is to simply drag and drop the extension folder onto *chrome://extensions* in your browser to load it. The extension will install/load right away. If you make some errors while creating the extension, it will not load and will display an error message at the top of the page. You have to rectify the error and then try again.

Figure 3: Our extension running in the browser-the text on the right is highlighted

Figure 4: Extension providing result for highlighted text in new tab of the Chrome browser

Running the extension

After installing/loading the extension, you can test it by highlighting some text and then selecting the *Wiki Search* option from the right-clicked context menu. As an example, we tested the extension by highlighting the word 'open source' on *http://opensourceforu.efytimes.com/* and then selected the *Wiki Search* option from the right-clicked context menu, as shown in Figure 3. This opened Wikipedia search results for 'open source' in a new tab in the Chrome browser, as shown in Figure 4. END

References

[1] *https://developer.chrome.com/extensions*
[2] *https://developer.chrome.com/extensions/getstarted*
[3] *https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Google_Chrome*
[4] *https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Google_Chrome_extension*

By: Aniket Eknath Kudale

The author is an open source enthusiast, who likes to play around with new technologies. He has over two years of work experience in this field. Currently, he works as a software engineer at Tibco Software Inc., Pune. His interests include Web technologies, computer vision and security. You can reach him at *kudale@aniket.co*.